The Tech Writers Troubleshooting Game

Yehoshua Paul





The Goals

- 5 basic troubleshooting challenges
- 1 “nothing else is working” challenge
- Find the fastest path to the solution
- Learn how to diagnose documentation issues

Game Setup

- Authoring tool (Flare)
- Version control system (Git)
- Software tracking system (Jira)
- Customer relationship management (CRM) tool (Salesforce)
- Help file storage system (server)



The secret of getting ahead is getting started

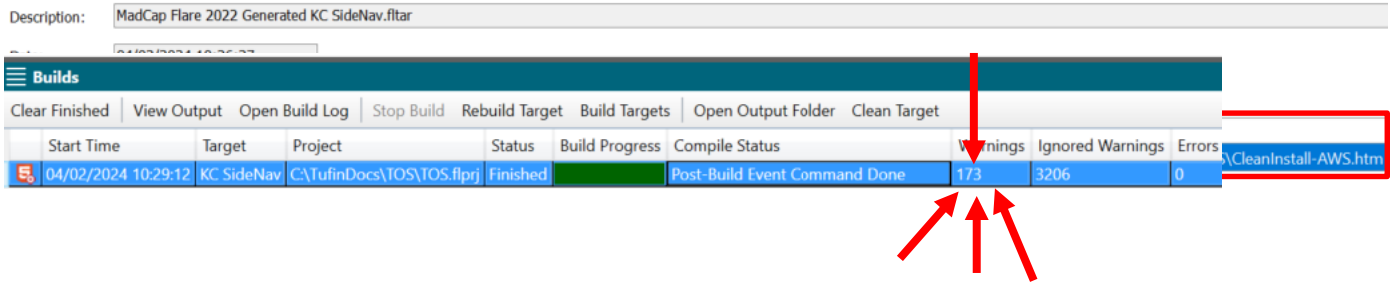
- Mark Twain

Log Files

- Use case: something broke
- What broke
- Where it broke



Examples

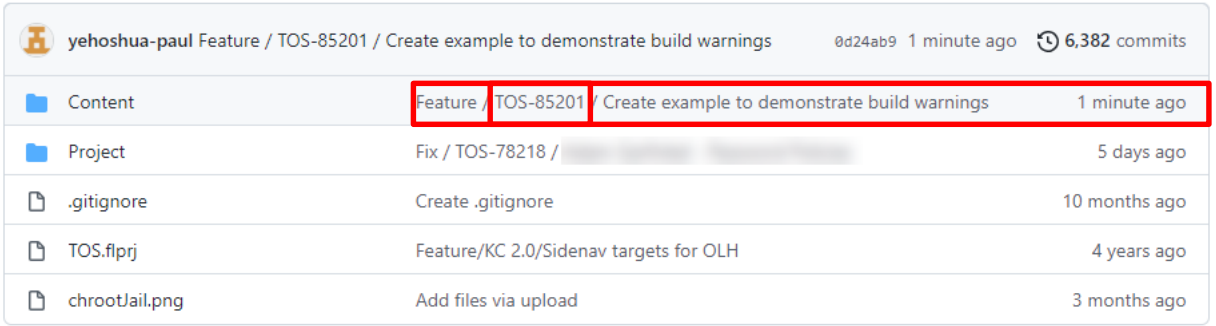

Description:
MadCap Flare 2022 Generated KC SideNav.fltar
Builds
Clear Finished
View Output
Open Build Log
Stop Build
Rebuild Target
Build Targets
Open Output Folder
Clean Target
Start Time
Target
Project
Status
Build Progress
Compile Status
Ignored Warnings
Errors
04/02/2024 10:29:12
KC SideNav
C:\TufinDocs\TOS\TOS.flprj
Finished
Post-Build Event Command Done
173
3206
0
\CleanInstall-AWS.htm

History

- Use case: something missing/changed
- When it changed
- Who changed it



Examples


yehoshua-paul Feature / TOS-85201 / Create example to demonstrate build warnings 0d24ab9 1 minute ago 6,382 commits
Content Feature / TOS-85201 / Create example to demonstrate build warnings 1 minute ago
Project Fix / TOS-78218 / 5 days ago
.gitignore Create .gitignore 10 months ago
TOS.flprj Feature/KC 2.0/Sidenav targets for OLH 4 years ago
chrootJail.png Add files via upload 3 months ago

Search

- Use case: Information gathering
- What features are included in the release?
- Which bugs need to be documented?
- What were you working on for the first major release of 2023?



Information Fields

- Use case:
  - Gathering even more information
  - Refining the search
- Who is the hidden SME?
- How far has development progressed?
- Which releases are impacted?

Categories	References	Affected Releases
Device Monitoring	TOS-79030 Case 123865	R22-2 and later
Device Monitoring	TOS-80793 Case 121065	R23-2 R24-1
Device Monitoring	TOS-81563 Case 115997	R22-2 R23-1



Philippe Keyaerts

SMALL WORLD

For 2-5 players • Ages 8 and above

Components

Inside **Small World™**, you will discover:

- 4 Maps of Small World, contained on two double-sided boards, one for each of the four possible player configurations



- 6 Player Summary sheets, one for each player and one to serve as a game turn reference for the group
- 14 Fantasy Race banners, colored when Active and grayed-out when In Decline, plus 1 blank banner for a race of your own design



Amazons, Active and In Decline

- 168 Matching Race tokens & 18 Lost Tribe tokens:



Amazons 8 Dwarves 11 Elves 10 Ghouls



11 Halflings 10 Humans 10 Orcs 10 Trolls 10 Wizards 18 Lost Tribes

SMALL WORLD

First player is the one whose ears are most pointed. Player clockwise. Final turn occurs when Game Turn marker reaches Turn track. Player with the most Victory coins then (or most

I. First Turn

1. Pick a Race & Special Power combo (p.

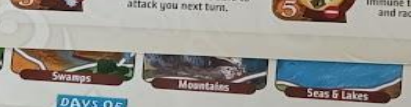
- Select a combo & pay 1 Victory coin on each combo abo
- Take your combo along with any Victory coins left on it
- Take a number of matching Race tokens equal to the su banner and Special Power badge.

2. Conquer some Regions (p. 4)

- **First Conquest:** Unless you are playing Halflings or a "Flyin conquer must be on the edge of the map or one of its 2
- **All Conquests:** Region must (usually) be adjacent to one tokens + 1 for each enemy Race token, Lost Tribe token Mountain or Troll's Lair in the Region. *If an opponent is pr 1 token and withdraws all others back in hand until that*
- **Final Conquest:** During your final conquest attempt for th Reinforcement die once after selecting your Region. Each *1 Token minimum: Regardless of your Race, Special Pow always use at least 1 Race token when conquering a Regi*
- **Troop Redeployment:** At turn's end, freely redeploy your tr at least one in each region. Opponents may redeploy troops conquered into others still under their control.

Te





Mine

DAYS OF WONDER

SMALL WORLD RACES



AMAZONS: During your Conquests, you may use 4 additional Amazons.



DWARVES: Collect 1 bonus coin for each Mine you occupy at turn's end, even when in decline.



ELVES: When conquered, you suffer no loss; withdraw all your tokens from the region.



GHOULS: Your Ghouls all stay on the map, when going into decline. In addition, they may continue to conquer new Regions during the following turns.



GIANTS: Conquer any Region adjacent to a Mountain Region you occupy at 1 less Giant token than usual. A minimum of 1 Giant token is still required.



HALFLINGS: Your first conquest may be anywhere. Also place a Hole-in-the-ground in the first 2 Regions you conquer to make them immune to opponents' conquests & racial & special powers.



HUMANS: Collect 1 bonus coin for each Farmland Region you occupy at turn's end.



ORCS: Collect 1 bonus coin for each *non-empty* Region you conquered this turn.



RATMEN: No Race benefit other than their sheer number!



SKELETONS: During Troop redeployment, take 1 new Skeleton token from the tray for every 2 non-empty regions you conquered and deploy it.



SORCERERS: Once per turn per opponent, substitute an opponent's single *active* token with a new Sorcerer token taken from the tray, to conquer an adjacent Region.



TRITONS: Conquer all coastal Regions bordering a Sea or Lake at 1 less Triton token than usual. A minimum of 1 Triton token is still required.



TROLLS: Place a Troll's Lair in each Region you occupy, to increase its defense by 1. Troll's Lairs stay when Trolls go in decline.



WIZARDS: Collect 1 bonus coin for each Magic Source you occupy at turn's end.

SPECIAL POWERS



ALCHEMIST: Collect 2 bonus coins every turn your tokens are on the map.



BERSERK: You may use the Reinforcement die before each Conquest.



BIVOUACKING: Deploy 5 Encampments in your Region(s). Each Encampment increases that Region's defense by 1.



COMMANDO: Conquer any Region using 1 less token than usual. A minimum of 1 token is still required.



DIPLOMAT: At the end of each turn, select 1 opponent whose active race you did not attack this turn. He won't be able to attack you next turn.



DRAGON MASTER: Use the Dragon to conquer a Region using a single token; the Region occupied by the Dragon becomes immune to opponents' conquests & racial & special powers.



FLYING: You may conquer any Region of the map, not just an adjacent one.



FOREST: Collect 1 bonus coin for each Forest Region you occupy at turn's end.



FORTIFIED: Once per turn, place a Fortress in a Region to increase its defense by 1 and collect 1 bonus coin (only when active). The Fortresses stay on the map even after your Race goes in decline.



HEROIC: At the end of your turn, place your 2 Heroes in Regions you occupy, to make these immune to opponents' conquests and racial & special powers.



HILL: Collect 1 bonus coin for each Hill Region you occupy at turn's end.



MERCHANT: Collect 1 bonus coin for *any* Region you occupy at turn's end.



MOUNTED: Conquer any Hill or Farmland Region at 1 less token than usual. A minimum of 1 token is still required.



PILLAGING: Collect 1 bonus coin for each *non-empty* Region you conquered this turn.



SEAFARING: When your Race is active, you may conquer Seas & Lakes as if they were empty Regions. You retain these Regions even after going into decline.



SPIRIT: When sent in decline, your Spirit tokens do not count toward the "only 1 race in decline" limit.



STOUT: You may go in decline at the end of a regular turn of conquests, after scoring.



SWAMP: Collect 1 bonus coin for each Swamp Region you occupy at turn's end.



UNDERWORLD: Conquer any Cavern Region at 1 less token than usual. A minimum of 1 token is still required. All Regions with a Cavern are considered adjacent.



WEALTHY: Collect 7 bonus coins, once only, at the end of your first turn on the map.

Software Tracking vs CRM

- Software tracking = R&D
- CRM = support and customers





“We didn’t lose the game; we just ran out of time”

- Vince Lombardi

Rules

1. Troubleshooting scenario is starting point
2. Choose between: log, Git history, Jira and Salesforce
3. Each choice = 1 step
4. Actions in each location = additional steps
5. Navigation with multiple elements = 1 step

Example: Go to github > R24-1 branch > file > file history = 1 step

Finding The Path



- Log points to files
- Files point to history
- History points to Jira
- Jira and Salesforce point to each other
- Jira and Salesforce provide much needed context.



Scenario 1 – Broken Build

Solution 1 - 6 steps

1. Build Log
2. File
3. Snippet file
4. Fix link
5. Save
6. Commit fix

Solution 2 - 5 steps

1. History
2. Snippet file
3. Fix link
4. Save
5. Commit fix

Scenario 2 – Content Is Wrong

Message from Support

In Monitoring > Monitoring Cisco ACI Devices > Step 6, the steps do not match the screenshot.

1. Monitoring
2. Jira
3. Update screenshot
4. Save
5. Commit changes

Scenario 3 – Hidden SME

Message from QA

After sending a bug description to QA for review, QA responds that the text should be reviewed by the support person who handled the case with the customer. How do you find that person?

1. Go to CRM
2. Reach out to SME

Scenario 4 – No Documentation

Message from Sales

In R23.2 PR1 10.0, we developed a new feature for retrieving NAT rule bindings per revision instead of per device. Why is this feature not documented in our knowledge center?

Solution 1 - 4 steps

1. Go to Jira
2. Search for R23-2 doc stories
3. Locate doc story
4. Reply to sales

Solution 2 - 5 steps

1. Verify request
2. Go to Jira
3. Search for R23-2 doc stories
4. Locate doc story
5. Reply to sales

Scenario 5 – Broken Build Again



Solution 1 - 8 steps

1. Build Log
2. History
3. Jira
4. Revert fix
5. Remove snippet from 3.90
6. Remove snippet from 3.100
7. Save
8. Commit fix

Solution 2 - 7 steps

1. History
2. Jira
3. Revert fix
4. Remove snippet from 3.90
5. Remove snippet from 3.100
6. Save
7. Commit fix

Nothing Else is Working





Conclusions

- Know your troubleshooting tools
- Processes are important
- Know which steps can be skipped and when
- NEVER delete a file without checking its links

Thanks!

Any questions?

You can contact me at:

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